6.4. Summary

The final piece of the data picture is the data your application generates as your consumers interact with it. In this chapter you learned:

- Application performance monitoring and business intelligence typically aren't measured by development teams.
- APM gives you insight into how well your application is built, and BI tells you how your consumers use it:
    - Server health statistics show you how well your application is performing.
    - Arbitrary stats and semantic logging give you measureable stats on how your application is being used.
    - Teams using a DevOps model are more likely to have access to APM data.
- Add arbitrary metrics collection to your code to collect application specific data. Netflix Servo and StatsD are popular open source libraries to help with this.
- Use logging best practices to get as much data as you can from your log analysis:
    - Use ISO8601-based timestamps.
    - Use unique IDs in your logs, but be careful of consumer data.
    - Use standard log categories and frameworks.
    - Pay attention to what your logs are telling you proactively.
    - Use formats that are easy to work with.
- Using social networks allows you to better connect with your consumers.
- Use arbitrary monitoring or semantic logging to provide feedback to the development team based on BI data to let them gauge effectiveness of new features.
- A variety of open source and commercial tools are available for application monitoring and collecting BI.